SSC CGL 2024 Tier-I question paper with answers

12 September 2024 · Shift 1

79 questions as the Staff Selection Commission (SSC) printed them · answers from the official key · marking: +2 for a right answer, –0.50 for a wrong one

The other 21 of the paper's 100 questions are not reproduced: they need a figure or are printed as an image, or ask about formatting the source does not keep.

Try every question first: the answer key and the explanations follow the questions. Official answer-key notice: https://ssc.gov.in/api/attachment/uploads/masterData/AnswerKeys/Writeup_Final_Anwerkey_CGLE_2024_T1_191224.pdf

Compare your score: the official 2024 cut-off (Tier-I, all posts except JSO and SI Grade-II), out of 200

UR 153.19 **OBC** 146.26 **EWS** 142.02 **SC** 126.46 **ST** 111.89 **ESM** 69.93 **OH** 113.10 **HH** 64.79 **VH** 102.97 **Other PwD** 45.74

Cut-offs apply to marks normalised across all the exam's shifts, so a raw score on one shift is a rough guide. Source: the official result write-up, https://ssc.gov.in/api/attachment/uploads/masterData/NoticeBoards/Result%20Write-up%20CGLE%202024%20Tier%20I_51224.pdf

General Intelligence and Reasoning 17 questions

Q.1

The position of how many letters will remain unchanged if all the letters in the word BINDER are arranged in English alphabetical order?

(A) One
(B) Three
(C) None
(D) Two

Q.2

In the following series, only one letter-cluster is incorrect. Select the incorrect letter-cluster. YCG IMQ SVZ CGK MQU

(A) CGK
(B) MQU
(C) SVZ
(D) IMQ

Q.3

Three of the following four options are alike in a certain way and thus form a group. Which is the one that does NOT belong to that group? (NOTE: Operations should be performed on the whole numbers, without breaking down the numbers into its constituent digits. E.g. 13 – Operations on 13 such as adding/subtracting/multiplying etc. to 13 can be performed. Breaking down 13 into 1 and 3 and then performing mathematical operations on 1 and 3 is not allowed.)

(A) 540 – 188 – 128
(B) 81– 101– 92
(C) 90 – 22– 12
(D) 72 – 284 – 266

Q.4

What will come in the place of the question mark (?) in the following equation, if '+' and '–' are interchanged and '×' and '÷' are interchanged? 342 × 18 + 79 – 45 ÷ 3 = ?

(A) 65
(B) 75
(C) 55
(D) 85

Q.5

Two sets of numbers are given below. In each set of numbers, certain mathematical operation(s) on the first number result(s) in the second number. Similarly, certain mathematical operation(s) on the second number result(s) in the third number and so on. Which of the given options follows the same set of operations as in the given sets? (NOTE: Operations should be performed on the whole numbers, without breaking down the numbers into their constituent digits. E.g. 13 – Operations on 13 such as adding/subtracting/multiplying to 13 can be performed. Breaking down 13 into 1 and 3 and then performing mathematical operations on 1 and 3 is not allowed.) 18 – 36 – 72 – 107; 15 – 30 – 60– 95

(A) 30 – 60 – 90 – 115
(B) 25 – 50 – 100 – 125
(C) 22 – 44 – 88 – 123
(D) 11 – 22 – 66 – 101

Q.6

Which of the following terms will replace the question mark (?) in the given series? IMHP, MPJQ, QSLR, UVNS, ?

(A) XYPT
(B) YYPT
(C) YXPT
(D) YYOT

Q.8

In a certain code language, ‘FACED’ is written as ‘GZDDE’ and ‘VACAY’ is written as ‘WZDZZ’. How will ‘LABOR’ be written in that language?

(A) MBCPS
(B) MZCNS
(C) MBDPS
(D) MADMS

Q.10

In a certain code language, 'FIVE' is written as '12184410' and FOUR is written as '12304236'. How will 'THREE' be written in that language?

(A) 4016361310
(B) 4016361010
(C) 4016361110
(D) 4016361212

Q.11

Three statements are given, followed by three conclusions numbered I, II and III. Assuming the statements to be true, even if they seem to be at variance with commonly known facts, decide which of the conclusions logically follow(s) from the statements. Statements: All pages are diaries. Some diaries are books. All books are notebooks. Conclusions: I. No page is a notebook. II. All pages are notebooks. III. All diaries being notebooks is a possibility.

(A) Both conclusion I and II follow
(B) Only conclusions I and III follow
(C) Only conclusion II follows
(D) Only conclusion III follows

Q.14

Select the word-pair that best represents a similar relationship to the one expressed in the pair of words given below. (The words must be considered as meaningful English words and must NOT be related to each other based on the number of letters/number of consonants/vowels in the word) Virus : Parasite

(A) Amaltas : Tree
(B) Fungus : Jasmine
(C) Algae : Flower
(D) Fenugreek : Micro organism

Q.15

Select the number from the given options to complete the series. 25, 30, 40, 55, 75, ___

(A) 80
(B) 100
(C) 105
(D) 85

Q.16

'WISK' is related to 'DRHP' in a certain way based on the English alphabetical order. In the same way, 'LENT' is related to 'OVMG'. To which of the following is 'BANG' related, following the same logic?

(A) ZYNS
(B) YZMT
(C) ZYLU
(D) YZNU

Q.19

Which two signs should be interchanged to make the following equation correct? 247 ÷ 13 + 16 × 3 – 148 = 119

(A) – and +
(B) ÷ and ×
(C) – and ×
(D) + and ×

Q.20

The position(s) of how many letters will remain unchanged if all the letters in the word 'ENTOMB' are arranged in English alphabetical order?

(A) One
(B) Two
(C) None
(D) Three

Q.22

Select the set in which the numbers are related in the same way as are the numbers of the given sets. (213, 157), (185, 129) (NOTE : Operations should be performed on the whole numbers, without breaking down the numbers into its constituent digits. E.g., 13 – Operations on 13 such as adding /deleting /multiplying etc. to 13 can be performed. Breaking down 13 into 1 and 3 and then performing mathematical operations on 1 and 3 is not allowed)

(A) (192, 152)
(B) (164, 108)
(C) (171, 123)
(D) (189, 141)

Q.23

In a certain code language, 'A + B' means 'A is the mother of B'; 'A – B' means 'A is the brother of B'; 'A × B' means 'A is the wife of B' and 'A ÷ B' means 'A is the father of B'. Based on the above, how is 4 related to 2 if '4 + 3 ÷ 2 ÷ 1 – 5'?

(A) Mother's father
(B) Father's father
(C) Mother's mother
(D) Father's mother

Q.24

Based on the English alphabetical order, three of the following four letter-clusters are alike in a certain way and thus form a group. Which is the one that DOES NOT belong to that group? (Note: The odd man out is not based on the number of consonants/vowels or their position in the letter-cluster.)

(A) FDZ
(B) JHD
(C) AYU
(D) KJE

General Awareness 24 questions

Q.1

The organisms that do not have a defined nucleus or organelles are classified in to _____ Kingdom.

(A) Fungi
(B) Monera
(C) Protista
(D) Plantae

Q.2

Kathakali, one of the classical dances of India, is predominantly performed in which of the following states of India?

(A) Uttar Pradesh
(B) Assam
(C) Kerala
(D) Manipur

Q.3

In 2002, Zakir Hussain became the youngest percussionist to be honoured with which award?

(A) Padma Bhushan
(B) National Heritage Fellowship
(C) Grammy Award
(D) Sangeet Natak Akademi Award

Q.4

Microbes like Rhizobium, Nitrosomonas and Nitrobacter are used for:

(A) carbon cycling
(B) nitrogen cycling
(C) water cycling
(D) sulphur cycling

Q.5

Which is the National Mission for Financial Inclusion to ensure access to financial services, namely, a basic savings and deposits accounts, remittance, credit, insurance, pension in an affordable manner?

(A) Swarnjayanti Gram Swarozgar Yojana
(B) Pradhan Mantri Jan Dhan Yojana
(C) Deendayal Antyodaya Yojana
(D) Deen Dayal Upadhyaya Grameen Kaushalya Yojana

Q.6

What is net investment?

(A) Gross investment + depreciation
(B) Gross investment - depreciation
(C) Gross capital investment - indirect taxes
(D) Sum of all the investments in a country

Q.8

In which state/UT is the Hemis festival celebrated?

(A) Sikkim
(B) Punjab
(C) Lakshadweep
(D) Ladakh

Q.9

A javelin thrown by an athlete is in _____ motion.

(A) rectilinear
(B) periodic
(C) curvilinear
(D) oscillatory

Q.10

Who among the following is the world renowned exponent of the bamboo flute?

(A) MS Subbulakshmi
(B) Hariprasad Chaurasia
(C) Ravi Shankar
(D) Bismillah Khan

Q.11

The magnificent Kailasa temple at Ellora was built during the reign of which Rashtrakuta king?

(A) Indra III
(B) Govinda III
(C) Krishna I
(D) Amoghavarsha

Q.12
Which Article of the Constitution of India provides that 'there shall be a Vice President of India'?

(A) Article 61
(B) Article 63
(C) Article 65
(D) Article 62

Q.13
Purvanchal Himalayas does NOT comprise of:

(A) Pir Panjal range
(B) Mizo hills
(C) Manipur hills
(D) Naga hills

Q.14
Which of the following plays was NOT written by Harshavardhana?

(A) Vikramorvasiyam
(B) Nagananda
(C) Ratnavali
(D) Priyadarshika

Q.15
In August 2022, the Ministry of Social Justice and Empowerment launched the _____ scheme, with an aim to provide comprehensive rehabilitation services to people engaged in begging in 75 municipalities.

(A) SMILE-75
(B) BEAM-75
(C) TWINKLE-75
(D) RISE-75

Q.16
A student, on his school assignment, is taking a session on how to make compost at home for using it at a park. Which fundamental duty is he performing?

(A) To strive towards excellence in all spheres of individual and collective activity
(B) To protect and improve the natural environment
(C) To develop the scientific temper, humanism and the spirit of inquiry
(D) To safeguard public property and to abjure violence

Q.17
India won the ICC Men Cricket World Cup for the first time in which of the following years?

(A) 1992
(B) 1987
(C) 1996
(D) 1983

Q.18
Calculate the oxidation number of 'S' in $H_2S_2O_7$.

(A) 3
(B) 7
(C) 2
(D) 6

Q.19
Which of the following is NOT an amendment made to the Airport Economic Regulatory Authority (AERA) Amendment Act, 2021?

(A) The government can call any airport a major airport just by notification.
(B) A major airport is one which has an annual traffic of minimum 35 lakh passengers.
(C) The government will club together profit-making and loss-making airports.
(D) The government can offer airports as a package in PPP mode to the prospective bidders.

Q.20
In which year did India make its Olympic debut in hockey?

(A) 1936
(B) 1928
(C) 1924
(D) 1932

Q.21
Who among the following was selected as the Sherpa for India's G20 hosted in 2022-23?

(A) Amitabh Kant
(B) Piyush Goyal
(C) Ashwini Vaishnav
(D) Shaktikanta Das

Q.22
With reference to Sepoy Mutiny of 1857, on which of the following dates did the soldiers at Meerut start their journey to Delhi?

(A) 29 March
(B) 10 May
(C) 2 June
(D) 19 April

Q.23
The green revolution technology resulted in an increase in production of cereal production from 72.4 million tons in 1965-66 to _____ million tons in 1978-79.

(A) 150.8
(B) 165.9
(C) 141.2
(D) 131.9

Q.24
Identify the oldest iron and steel company of India from the following options.

(A) Mysore Iron & Steel Works
(B) Tata Iron & Steel Company(TISCO)
(C) Visvesvaraiya Iron & Steel Works
(D) Indian Iron & Steel Company (IISCO)

Q.25
Which of the following is the largest artificial lake of Asia?

(A) Chilika Lake
(B) Dal Lake
(C) Bhopal Lake
(D) Naini Lake

Quantitative Aptitude 14 questions

Q.1
Which digits should come in place * and $, respectively, if the number 72864*$ is divisible by both 8 and 5?

(A) 4 and 5
(B) 2 and 0
(C) 4 and 0
(D) 2 and 5

Q.2
A shopkeeper marked an article at ₹5,000. The shopkeeper allows successive discounts of 20%, 15% and 10%. The selling price of the article is:

(A) ₹3,060
(B) ₹2,750
(C) ₹3,000
(D) ₹2,800

Q.3
The measures of the three angles of a triangle are in the ratio 17 : 13 : 15. Find the positive difference between the greatest and the smallest of these three angles.

(A) 24°
(B) 20°
(C) 16°
(D) 12°

Q.4
A certain sum of money becomes seven times itself when invested at a certain rate of simple interest, in 14 years. How much time (in years, rounded off to 2 decimal places) will it take to become 18 times itself at the same rate?

(A) 35.5
(B) 27.33
(C) 42.78
(D) 39.67

Q.5

In a triangle PQR, S is a point on the side QR such that PS⊥QR, then which of the following options is true?

(A) $PS^2 + QS^2 = PQ^2 + PR^2$

(B) $PS^2 + PR^2 = PQ^2 + QR^2$

(C) $PQ^2 + PR^2 = QS^2 + SR^2$

(D) $PR^2 + QS^2 = PQ^2 + SR^2$

Q.6

M and N walk along a circular track. They start at 5:00 a.m. from the same point in the opposite directions. M and N walk at a speed of 5 rounds per hour and 2 rounds per hour, respectively. How many times will they cross each other before 6.30 a.m. on the same day?

(A) 3

(B) 7

(C) 10

(D) 5

Q.7

Two pipes, A and B, can fill a tank in 10 minutes and 20 minutes, respectively. The pipe C can empty the tank in 30 minutes. All the three pipes are opened at a time in the beginning. However, pipe C is closed 2 minutes before the tank is filled. In what time, will the tank be full (in minutes)?

(A) 10

(B) 8

(C) 12

(D) 6

Q.9

The incomes of P, Q and R are in the ratio 10 : 12 : 9 and their expenditures are in the ratio 12 : 15 : 8. If Q saves 25% of his income, then what is the ratio of the savings of P, Q and R?

(A) 21 : 14 : 15

(B) 15 : 14 : 21

(C) 21 : 15 : 14

(D) 14 : 15 : 21

Q.11

The average of 12 numbers is 48. The average of the first 5 numbers is 45 and the average of next 4 numbers is 52. If the 10th number is 10 less than the 11th number and is 5 more than the 12th number, then the average of the 11th and 12th numbers is:

(A) 48.5

(B) 47.5

(C) 46.5

(D) 50.5

Q.15

Raj divides ₹1,200 in the ratio 2 : 1 : 3 among three of his friends. The amount equal to the sum of three times the largest share and two times the smallest share is:

(A) ₹1,800

(B) ₹2,400

(C) ₹2,000

(D) ₹2,200

Q.17

In triangles ABC and DEF, AB = FD and ∠A = ∠D. The two triangles are congruent by SAS criterion if:

(A) AC = DE

(B) AC = EF

(C) BC = DE

(D) BC = EF

Q.19

If 28.9 : x :: x : 36.1, and x > 0, then find the value of x.

(A) 38.3

(B) 30.4

(C) 35

(D) 32.3

Q.20

A payment of ₹120 is made with ₹10, ₹5 and ₹2 coins. A total of 25 coins are used. Which of the following is the number of ₹10 coins used in the payment?

(A) 10
(B) 4
(C) 8
(D) 6

Q.23

Simplify 15.5 – [3 – {7 – (5 – (14.5 – 13.5))}].

(A) 15.5
(B) 13.5
(C) 14.5
(D) 12.5

English Comprehension 24 questions

Q.1

Identity the most appropriate ANTONYM of the given word. Secure

(A) Trundle
(B) Save
(C) Succeed
(D) Attack

Q.2

Select the most appropriate synonym of the given word. Acquiesce

(A) Thwart
(B) Cease
(C) Desist
(D) Concur

Q.3

Select the option that can be used as a one-word substitute for the underlined group of words. In Indian mythology, most of the Asuras wish to be “never able to die”.

(A) Immortal
(B) Invisible
(C) Impervious
(D) Invincible

Q.4

Sentences of a paragraph are given below in jumbled order. Arrange the sentences in the correct order to form a meaningful and coherent paragraph. A. The genuine beliefs, though not unconsciously acquired by most children; and even if they depart from these beliefs in later life B. Something of them remains deeply implanted, ready to emerge in a time of stress of crisis C. The importance of education in forming character and opinion is very great and well recognised by all D. Education is, as a rule, the strongest force on the side of what exists and again fundamental change

(A) DABC
(B) CBAD
(C) DCAB
(D) CABD

Q.5

Select the most appropriate meaning of the underlined idiom in the following sentence. In my new office, all employees were different, so I felt like a “fish out of water”.

(A) Disappointed
(B) Frustrated
(C) Homeless
(D) Uncomfortable

Q.6

Select the most appropriate synonym of the bracketed word in the following sentence to fill in the blank. During Covid times, many organisations made _____(sentimental) appeals to raise funds for migrant workers.

(A) practical
(B) mawkish
(C) cynical
(D) sincere

Q.7

Select the option that will improve the underlined part of the given sentence. If I “was the queen”, I would give a handsome sum towards education.

(A) will be the queen
(B) would be the queen
(C) have been the queen
(D) were the queen

Q.8

Select the INCORRECTLY spelt word.

(A) Embarrass
(B) Accommodate
(C) Exhilerate
(D) Occurrence

Q.10

Select the option that expresses the following sentence in passive voice. Sonam does not like bananas.

(A) Bananas had not been liked by Sonam.
(B) Bananas have not been liked by Sonam.
(C) Bananas are not liked by Sonam.
(D) Banana is not liked by Sonam.

Q.11

Select the most appropriate synonym for the underlined word in the given sentence. His “ambition” in life is to become a happy and satisfied man.

(A) Eagerness
(B) Amend
(C) Satisfaction
(D) Apathy

Q.12

Read the sentence carefully and select the most suitable idiom to fill in the blank. The renowned publisher decided to withdraw a book from the market. No one was interested in the book as the arguments presented were _____.

(A) under the rose
(B) high and mighty
(C) beside the mark
(D) out of the woods

Q.13

The following sentence has been divided into four segments. Identify the segment that contains an error. Mrs. Sreelakshmi’s / musical intelligence / is superior than / Mrs. Suma’s.

(A) Mrs. Sreelakshmi’s
(B) musical intelligence
(C) Mrs. Suma’s.
(D) is superior than

Q.14

Select the most appropriate meaning of the underlined word in the given sentence. He is an “atheist”, although he respects everyone’s belief.

(A) One who believes in nature
(B) One who does not believe in God
(C) One who believes in God
(D) One who is extremist

Q.15

Select the most appropriate ANTONYM of the given word. Receive

(A) Reward
(B) Admit
(C) Exile
(D) Fund

Q.16

Select the most appropriate option to substitute the underlined segment in the given sentence. Gourav was “no good” than a foolish person.

(A) no best
(B) not good
(C) no better
(D) not best

Q.17

Select the option that expresses the given sentence in passive voice Someone has taken my secret diary.

(A) My secret diary has to be taken by someone.
(B) My secret diary had been taken by someone.
(C) My secret diary will have been taken by someone.
(D) My secret diary has been taken by someone.

Q.18

Select the option that can be used as a one-word substitute for the given group of words. That which cannot be conquered

(A) Ineffable
(B) Indelible
(C) Invisible
(D) Invincible

Q.19

Select the option that corrects the error in the given sentence. He ran quick to catch the bus.

(A) insipid
(B) rapid
(C) quiet
(D) quickly

Q.20

Select the option that can be used as a one-word-substitute for the given group of words. “A false idea or belief”

(A) Entropy
(B) Fallacy
(C) Reticence
(D) Atrophy

Q.21

In the following passage, some words have been deleted. Read the passage carefully and select the most appropriate option to fill in each blank. The beginning of the story is (1)_____ in its presentation but (2)_____ the style eases out and becomes haunting in its simplicity. The author brings out the human elements in his story. This common element of sympathy and sacrifice is given a new (3)_____ by the old artist who shows by his last desperate act that one can be a hero for one day if only one cares (4)_____. O Henry’s treatment of his material is balanced and controlled, a fine (5)_____ of humour and pathos.

Select the most appropriate option to fill in blank number 1.

(A) prone
(B) delectable
(C) quaint
(D) habitual

Q.22

In the following passage, some words have been deleted. Read the passage carefully and select the most appropriate option to fill in each blank. The beginning of the story is (1)_____ in its presentation but (2)_____ the style eases out and becomes haunting in its simplicity. The author brings out the human elements in his story. This common element of sympathy and sacrifice is given a new (3)_____ by the old artist who shows by his last desperate act that one can be a hero for one day if only one cares (4)_____. O Henry’s treatment of his material is balanced and controlled, a fine (5)_____ of humour and pathos.

Select the most appropriate option to fill in blank number 2.

(A) hardly
(B) gradually
(C) recently
(D) initially

Q.23

In the following passage, some words have been deleted. Read the passage carefully and select the most appropriate option to fill in each blank. The beginning of the story is (1)_____ in its presentation but (2)_____ the style eases out and becomes haunting in its simplicity. The author brings out the human elements in his story. This common element of sympathy and sacrifice is given a new (3)_____ by the old artist who shows by his last desperate act that one can be a hero for one day if only one cares (4)_____. O Henry's treatment of his material is balanced and controlled, a fine (5)_____ of humour and pathos.

Select the most appropriate option to fill in blank number 3.

(A) infection
(B) condition
(C) supervision
(D) dimension

Q.24

In the following passage, some words have been deleted. Read the passage carefully and select the most appropriate option to fill in each blank. The beginning of the story is (1)_____ in its presentation but (2)_____ the style eases out and becomes haunting in its simplicity. The author brings out the human elements in his story. This common element of sympathy and sacrifice is given a new (3)_____ by the old artist who shows by his last desperate act that one can be a hero for one day if only one cares (4)_____. O Henry's treatment of his material is balanced and controlled, a fine (5)_____ of humour and pathos.

Select the most appropriate option to fill in blank number 4.

(A) enough
(B) tough
(C) through
(D) though

Q.25

In the following passage, some words have been deleted. Read the passage carefully and select the most appropriate option to fill in each blank. The beginning of the story is (1)_____ in its presentation but (2)_____ the style eases out and becomes haunting in its simplicity. The author brings out the human elements in his story. This common element of sympathy and sacrifice is given a new (3)_____ by the old artist who shows by his last desperate act that one can be a hero for one day if only one cares (4)_____. O Henry's treatment of his material is balanced and controlled, a fine (5)_____ of humour and pathos.

Select the most appropriate option to fill in blank number 5.

(A) ascend
(B) blend
(C) legend
(D) amend

Answer key

General Intelligence and Reasoning

Q.1 **(D)**	Q.2 **(C)**	Q.3 **(D)**	Q.4 **(B)**	Q.5 **(C)**	Q.6 **(B)**
Q.8 **(B)**	Q.10 **(B)**	Q.11 **(D)**	Q.14 **(A)**	Q.15 **(B)**	Q.16 **(B)**
Q.19 **(A)**	Q.20 **(C)**	Q.22 **(B)**	Q.23 **(D)**	Q.24 **(D)**	

General Awareness

Q.1 **(B)**	Q.2 **(C)**	Q.3 **(A)**	Q.4 **(B)**	Q.5 **(B)**	Q.6 **(B)**
Q.8 **(D)**	Q.9 **(C)**	Q.10 **(B)**	Q.11 **(C)**	Q.12 **(B)**	Q.13 **(A)**
Q.14 **(A)**	Q.15 **(A)**	Q.16 **(B)**	Q.17 **(D)**	Q.18 **(D)**	Q.19 **(B)**
Q.20 **(B)**	Q.21 **(A)**	Q.22 **(B)**	Q.23 **(D)**	Q.24 **(B)**	Q.25 **(C)**

Quantitative Aptitude

Q.1 **(C)**	Q.2 **(A)**	Q.3 **(C)**	Q.4 **(D)**	Q.5 **(D)**	Q.6 **(C)**
Q.7 **(B)**	Q.9 **(D)**	Q.11 **(A)**	Q.15 **(D)**	Q.17 **(A)**	Q.19 **(D)**
Q.20 **(C)**	Q.23 **(A)**				

English Comprehension

Q.1 **(D)**	Q.2 **(D)**	Q.3 **(A)**	Q.4 **(D)**	Q.5 **(D)**	Q.6 **(B)**
Q.7 **(D)**	Q.8 **(C)**	Q.10 **(C)**	Q.11 **(A)**	Q.12 **(C)**	Q.13 **(D)**
Q.14 **(B)**	Q.15 **(C)**	Q.16 **(C)**	Q.17 **(D)**	Q.18 **(D)**	Q.19 **(D)**
Q.20 **(B)**	Q.21 **(C)**	Q.22 **(B)**	Q.23 **(D)**	Q.24 **(A)**	Q.25 **(B)**

Explanations

General Intelligence and Reasoning

Q.1 · Answer (D) Two

BINDER in alphabetical order is B D E I N R. B (1st) and R (6th) keep their places: two letters.

Q.2 · Answer (C) SVZ

In each correct cluster the letters move +4, +4 (YCG, IMQ, CGK, MQU), and each cluster starts 10 letters after the one before. The third should be SWA; SVZ moves +3, then +4.

Q.3 · Answer (D) 72 – 284 – 266

In 540 – 188 – 128, 81 – 101 – 92 and 90 – 22 – 12 the first number is 9 times the difference of the other two (9 × 60, 9 × 9, 9 × 10). In 72 – 284 – 266, 9 × 18 = 162, not 72.

Q.4 · Answer (B) 75

After interchanging the signs: 342 ÷ 18 – 79 + 45 × 3 = 19 – 79 + 135 = 75.

Q.5 · Answer (C) 22 – 44 – 88 – 123

Each set doubles twice and then adds 35: 18 → 36 → 72 → 107 and 15 → 30 → 60 → 95. Likewise 22 → 44 → 88 → 123.

Q.6 · Answer (B) YYPT

First letters move +4 (I, M, Q, U, Y), second letters +3 (M, P, S, V, Y), third letters +2 (H, J, L, N, P) and fourth letters +1 (P, Q, R, S, T): YYPT.

Q.8 · Answer (B) MZCNS

The letters move +1, –1, +1, –1, +1: FACED → GZDDE and VACAY → WZDZZ. So LABOR → MZCNS.

Q.10 · Answer (B) 4016361010

Each letter is written as twice its position in the alphabet: F, I, V, E → 12, 18, 44, 10. So T, H, R, E, E → 40, 16, 36, 10, 10: 4016361010.

Q.11 · Answer (D) Only conclusion III follows

Only the diaries that are books are certainly notebooks, and pages may or may not be among them, so neither I nor II follows. Nothing rules out every diary being a book, and so a notebook: III follows.

Q.14 · Answer (A) Amaltas : Tree

A virus is a kind of parasite, as the amaltas is a kind of tree.

Q.15 · Answer (B) 100

The differences grow by 5 (+5, +10, +15, +20), so the next is +25: 75 + 25 = 100.

Q.16 · Answer (B) YZMT

Each letter is replaced by its opposite letter in the alphabet (A↔Z, B↔Y and so on): W→D, I→R, S→H, K→P and L→O, E→V, N→M, T→G. So B→Y, A→Z, N→M, G→T: YZMT.

Q.19 · Answer (A) – and +

Interchanging – and +: 247 ÷ 13 – 16 × 3 + 148 = 19 – 48 + 148 = 119.

Q.20 · Answer (C) None

ENTOMB in alphabetical order is B E M N O T. Position by position (E/B, N/E, T/M, O/N, M/O, B/T) no letter stays where it was.

Q.22 · Answer (B) (164, 108)

In each set the second number is 56 less than the first: 213 – 56 = 157 and 185 – 56 = 129. Likewise 164 – 56 = 108.

Q.23 · Answer (D) Father's mother

4 is the mother of 3, and 3 is the father of 2. So 4 is 2's father's mother.

Q.24 · Answer (D) KJE
In FDZ, JHD and AYU the letters move back 2, then back 4 (counting round from A to Z). In KJE they move back 1, then back 5.

General Awareness

Q.1 · Answer (B) Monera
Monera (bacteria and blue-green algae) are prokaryotes, with no defined nucleus or membrane-bound organelles. Fungi, Protista and Plantae are all eukaryotes.

Q.2 · Answer (C) Kerala
Kathakali, the dance-drama with elaborate make-up and costumes, is the classical dance of Kerala.

Q.3 · Answer (A) Padma Bhushan
Zakir Hussain was awarded the Padma Bhushan in 2002, after the Padma Shri in 1988.

Q.4 · Answer (B) nitrogen cycling
Rhizobium fixes atmospheric nitrogen in the root nodules of legumes, Nitrosomonas turns ammonia into nitrite and Nitrobacter turns nitrite into nitrate: all steps of the nitrogen cycle.

Q.5 · Answer (B) Pradhan Mantri Jan Dhan Yojana
Pradhan Mantri Jan Dhan Yojana, launched in August 2014, is the National Mission for Financial Inclusion.

Q.6 · Answer (B) Gross investment - depreciation
Net investment is gross investment less depreciation, the part of the capital stock used up during the year.

Q.8 · Answer (D) Ladakh
The Hemis festival is held at Hemis Monastery in Ladakh to mark the birth anniversary of Guru Padmasambhava.

Q.9 · Answer (C) curvilinear
A thrown javelin follows a curved path, so its motion is curvilinear; rectilinear motion is along a straight line.

Q.10 · Answer (B) Hariprasad Chaurasia
Pandit Hariprasad Chaurasia is the best-known exponent of the bansuri, the bamboo flute. M.S. Subbulakshmi was a Carnatic vocalist, Ravi Shankar a sitar player and Bismillah Khan a shehnai player.

Q.11 · Answer (C) Krishna I
The Kailasa temple at Ellora, cut from a single rock, was built under the Rashtrakuta king Krishna I in the 8th century.

Q.12 · Answer (B) Article 63
Article 63 reads 'There shall be a Vice-President of India'.

Q.13 · Answer (A) Pir Panjal range
The Purvanchal hills comprise the Patkai Bum, Naga hills, Manipur hills and Mizo hills. The Pir Panjal range is in the western Himalayas, in Jammu and Kashmir and Himachal Pradesh.

Q.14 · Answer (A) Vikramorvasiyam
Harshavardhana wrote the Sanskrit plays Nagananda, Ratnavali and Priyadarshika; 'Vikramorvasiyam' is Kalidasa's.

Q.15 · Answer (A) SMILE-75
Under SMILE-75, launched in August 2022 as part of the SMILE scheme (Support for Marginalised Individuals for Livelihood and Enterprise), 75 municipal corporations rehabilitate people engaged in begging.

Q.16 · Answer (B) To protect and improve the natural environment
Making compost and using it in a park helps protect and improve the natural environment, the duty in Article 51A(g).

Q.17 · Answer (D) 1983
India first won the Men's Cricket World Cup in 1983, under Kapil Dev, beating the West Indies in the final at Lord's.

Q.18 · Answer (D) 6
With H at +1 and O at –2: 2(+1) + 2x + 7(–2) = 0, so 2x = 12 and x = +6.

Q.19 · Answer (B) A major airport is one which has an annual traffic of minimum 35 lakh passengers.
SSC's key gives the 35-lakh threshold, which came in with the 2019 amendment (raising it from 15 lakh). The 2021 amendment let the government group airports, profit-making with loss-making, notify the group as a major airport and offer it as a package for PPP bids. (The power to notify any airport as a major airport was also in the Act before 2021.)

Q.20 · Answer (B) 1928
India first played Olympic hockey at Amsterdam in 1928, and won the gold medal.

Q.21 · Answer (A) Amitabh Kant
Amitabh Kant, former CEO of NITI Aayog, was appointed India's G20 Sherpa in July 2022, succeeding Piyush Goyal.

Q.22 · Answer (B) 10 May
The sepoys at Meerut rose on 10 May 1857 and set out for Delhi, which they reached the next day.

Q.23 · Answer (D) 131.9
SSC's key gives 131.9 million tonnes, India's total foodgrain output (cereals and pulses together) in 1978-79, up from about 72 million tonnes in 1965-66.

Q.24 · Answer (B) Tata Iron & Steel Company(TISCO)
SSC's key gives TISCO, registered in 1907 at Jamshedpur. IISCO was formed in 1918, and the Mysore Iron Works at Bhadravati, later named after Visvesvaraya, in 1923. (In 1936 IISCO took over the Kulti works of the Bengal Iron Company, whose history goes back to the 1870s.)

Q.25 · Answer (C) Bhopal Lake
Of these, only Bhopal's Upper Lake (Bhojtal), traditionally credited to the Paramara king Bhoja in the 11th century, is man-made, and SSC's key gives it; it is often called Asia's largest artificial lake, though reservoirs such as Govind Ballabh Pant Sagar (Rihand) are larger. Chilika is a natural lagoon, and Dal and Naini are natural lakes.

Quantitative Aptitude

Q.1 · Answer (C) 4 and 0
Divisible by both 5 and 8, the number must end in 0, so $ = 0. The last three digits, 4*0, must then be divisible by 8: of the options, 440 is (8 × 55), so * = 4.

Q.2 · Answer (A) ₹3,060
Successive discounts leave 0.8 × 0.85 × 0.9 = 0.612 of the price: ₹5,000 × 0.612 = ₹3,060.

Q.3 · Answer (C) 16°
17 + 13 + 15 = 45 parts make 180°, so one part is 4°. The difference between the greatest and the smallest is (17 – 13) × 4° = 16°.

Q.4 · Answer (D) 39.67
Becoming 7 times itself means interest of 6 times the sum in 14 years. Becoming 18 times needs interest of 17 times the sum: 14 × 17/6 = 39.67 years.

Q.5 · Answer (D) $PR^2 + QS^2 = PQ^2 + SR^2$
By Pythagoras in the right triangles PSQ and PSR: $PQ^2 = PS^2 + QS^2$ and $PR^2 = PS^2 + SR^2$. Subtracting, $PQ^2 – QS^2 = PR^2 – SR^2$, so $PR^2 + QS^2 = PQ^2 + SR^2$.

Q.6 · Answer (C) 10

Walking in opposite directions they close 5 + 2 = 7 rounds an hour on each other and cross each time they close one round. In 1.5 hours that is 10.5 rounds: 10 crossings.

Q.7 · Answer (B) 8

If the tank fills in t minutes, C is open for t – 2: t/10 + t/20 – (t – 2)/30 = 1. Multiplying by 60: 6t + 3t – 2t + 4 = 60, so t = 8.

Q.9 · Answer (D) 14 : 15 : 21

Let the incomes be 10k, 12k, 9k and the expenditures 12m, 15m, 8m. Q saves 3k, so 15m = 9k and m = 0.6k. Savings: 10k – 7.2k = 2.8k, 3k and 9k – 4.8k = 4.2k, i.e. 14 : 15 : 21.

Q.11 · Answer (A) 48.5

The last three numbers total 576 – 225 – 208 = 143. With the 10th = a, the 11th is a + 10 and the 12th a – 5, so 3a + 5 = 143 and a = 46. The 11th and 12th are 56 and 41: average 48.5.

Q.15 · Answer (D) ₹2,200

The shares are ₹400, ₹200 and ₹600. 3 × 600 + 2 × 200 = ₹2,200.

Q.17 · Answer (A) AC = DE

For SAS the equal angles must lie between the equal sides. ∠A lies between AB and AC, and ∠D between DF and DE; with AB = FD already, AC = DE is needed.

Q.19 · Answer (D) 32.3

x is the mean proportional: $x^2 = 28.9 \times 36.1 = (17^2 \times 19^2)/100$, so x = 17 × 19/10 = 32.3.

Q.20 · Answer (C) 8

With a, b and c coins of ₹10, ₹5 and ₹2: 10a + 5b + 2c = 120 and a + b + c = 25, so 8a + 3b = 70. Of the options only a = 8 gives a whole number of ₹5 coins: b = 2 and c = 15 (80 + 10 + 30 = 120).

Q.23 · Answer (A) 15.5

Innermost first: 14.5 – 13.5 = 1, 5 – 1 = 4, 7 – 4 = 3 and 3 – 3 = 0, leaving 15.5 – 0 = 15.5.

English Comprehension

Q.1 · Answer (D) Attack

To 'secure' something is to make it safe from harm; to 'attack' it is the opposite. 'Save' is close to a synonym.

Q.2 · Answer (D) Concur

To 'acquiesce' is to accept or agree without protest: to 'concur'. 'Thwart', 'cease' and 'desist' do not mean agreeing.

Q.3 · Answer (A) Immortal

'Immortal' means never able to die. 'Invincible' means impossible to defeat, and 'impervious' unaffected.

Q.4 · Answer (D) CABD

C states the importance of education in forming character and opinion; A, on the beliefs children acquire, and B, 'something of them remains', develop it; D concludes that education is the strongest force on the side of what exists: CABD.

Q.5 · Answer (D) Uncomfortable

To feel like 'a fish out of water' is to feel uncomfortable in unfamiliar surroundings.

Q.6 · Answer (B) mawkish

'Mawkish' means sentimental, often excessively so. 'Practical' and 'cynical' point the other way, and 'sincere' means genuine.

Q.7 · Answer (D) were the queen

An imagined, unreal condition takes the subjunctive 'were': 'If I were the queen, I would give ...'

Q.8 · Answer (C) Exhilerate
The correct spelling is 'exhilarate'.

Q.10 · Answer (C) Bananas are not liked by Sonam.
The simple present 'does not like' becomes 'are not liked', agreeing with the plural 'bananas': 'Bananas are not liked by Sonam.'

Q.11 · Answer (A) Eagerness
'Ambition' is a strong desire to achieve something; of the options 'eagerness' comes closest. 'Apathy' is its opposite.

Q.12 · Answer (C) beside the mark
'Beside the mark' means irrelevant, missing the point, which is why no one was interested in the book.

Q.13 · Answer (D) is superior than
'Superior' takes 'to', not 'than': 'is superior to Mrs. Suma's'.

Q.14 · Answer (B) One who does not believe in God
An 'atheist' is one who does not believe in God; one who does is a 'theist'.

Q.15 · Answer (C) Exile
To 'receive' someone is to welcome or admit them; to 'exile' them is to send them away. 'Admit' is close to a synonym.

Q.16 · Answer (C) no better
'Than' needs a comparative: 'no better than a foolish person'.

Q.17 · Answer (D) My secret diary has been taken by someone.
The present perfect 'has taken' becomes 'has been taken': 'My secret diary has been taken by someone.'

Q.18 · Answer (D) Invincible
'Invincible' means too strong to be conquered or defeated. 'Ineffable' means too great to be described, and 'indelible' impossible to remove.

Q.19 · Answer (D) quickly
The verb 'ran' needs the adverb 'quickly', not the adjective 'quick'.

Q.20 · Answer (B) Fallacy
A fallacy is a mistaken idea or belief. 'Atrophy' is wasting away, 'reticence' is reserve, and 'entropy' is disorder.

Q.21 · Answer (C) quaint
The opening is 'quaint', attractively unusual or old-fashioned, in its presentation, in contrast with the simplicity that follows.

Q.22 · Answer (B) gradually
'But gradually the style eases out': the change comes little by little as the story goes on.

Q.23 · Answer (D) dimension
The old artist gives the common theme of sympathy and sacrifice a new 'dimension', a new aspect.

Q.24 · Answer (A) enough
'If only one cares enough': 'enough' fits after the verb; 'tough', 'through' and 'though' do not.

Q.25 · Answer (B) blend
'A fine blend of humour and pathos': a mixture of the two.

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